Source: 'Twitter Listening Post': Sanjeev Singh, Rishabh Srivastava, Nalin Mehta, https://pollniti.com/twitter.html

Table 7.1: Rahul Gandhi vs Narendra Modi; BJP vs Congress on Twitter: Followers (2017–2019)

Name	*Total*	*Growth (in Million)*	*Growth %*
Rahul Gandhi	9.67	+7.52	+349.22
Narendra Modi	47.73	+17.35	+57.10
BJP	11.16	+6.05	+116.3
INC	5.26	+3.32	+171.42

Source: CrowdTangle Intelligence Report Data analysed by Nalin Mehta, Rishabh Srivastava (31 May 2017–31 May 2019)

Importantly, this Twitter trend was replicated when we started examining second-level Congress and BJP leaders in the states. In particular, we looked at Congress leaders in Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh in the months leading up to state assembly elections in December 2018. In all these three states, Congress official handles and those of its key leaders (Ashok Gehlot and Sachin Pilot in Rajasthan; Kamal Nath and Jyotiraditya Scindia [before he switched to the BJP on 11 March 2020] in Madhya Pradesh; Bhupesh Bhagel and T.S. Singh Deo in Chhattisgarh) significantly outperformed official BJP handles and those of its main leaders (Vasundhara Raje Scindia in Rajasthan; Shivraj Singh Chouhan in Madhya Pradesh and Raman Singh in Chhattisgarh) on key engagement metrics. Our data recorded in the months of October-November 2018 clearly shows that the Congress was winning the Twitter battle at the regional level in these states.

Figure 7.5: Rahul Gandhi vs Narendra Modi; BJP vs Congress on Twitter: Interaction Rate (2017–2019)